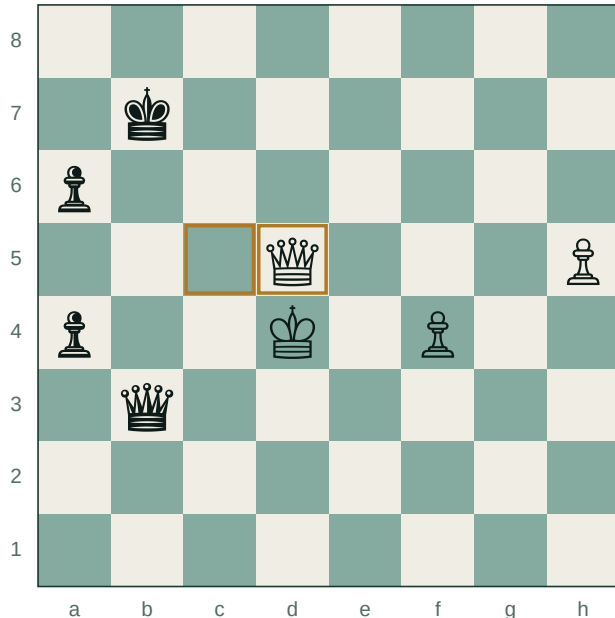


# Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 55

Advanced-pawn tactics

## Black to move



Previous move: 55.Qd5+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

**55...Qxd5+ 56. Kxd5 a3 57. h6 a2**

**55...Qxd5+** Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on d5. Recorded reply: **56.Kxd5**.

**56...a3** The pawn moves from a4 to a3. Recorded reply: **57.h6**.

**57...a2** The pawn moves from a3 to a2.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

## HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on d4. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.